Q+A

NOT AFRAID TO FAIL

Last seen in the recently released *Vikram Vedha*, actress **Radhika Apte** says she wants to avoid mediocrity by writing and directing her own projects in the future



MANDAR DEODHAR

Q. You have always presented yourself as an assertive actor. What has the journey been like for you?

I am really not afraid of failing. It is not confidence but acceptance. I don't have the fear of being in front of the camera that I used to have back in the day. Perhaps that's why I appear confident. What isthe worst that can happen? You can tell me that you didn't like my film? Now, that's really not scary at all.

Q. *Vikram Vedha* and your upcoming film *Monica, O My Darling* are technically both set in neo-noir worlds, but they seem to make very different demands of you...

Monica, O My Darling is a film that really challenged me as an actor. The kind of humour that director Vasan Bala demanded from me was really tough. In contrast, *Vikram Vedha* was something I was more comfortable doing because it's something I've done before.

Q. What about *Vikram Vedha* appealed to you the most?

There are always action movies, across Bollywood and other industries in Indian cinema that have tackled what good and bad mean. Personally, I've always had a problem with restricting stories to these binaries, and that is exactly what *Vikram Vedha* challenges. Even my character in the film, despite being a small role, poses a relevant question on how we can navigate a world where people are taking extreme sides.

Q. What does the future hold for you?

I'm not a big planner at all. But I've decided to choose less work, much less work than I used to. I'm also studying scriptwriting, so I don't have time to do much work anyway. The pandemic gave me the opportunity to start writing, and the more I wrote, the more I wanted to study it. This came out of feeling not that great about the work that was coming my way. I don't know how this will pan out, but I would really like to write and direct, too.

with Arman Khan